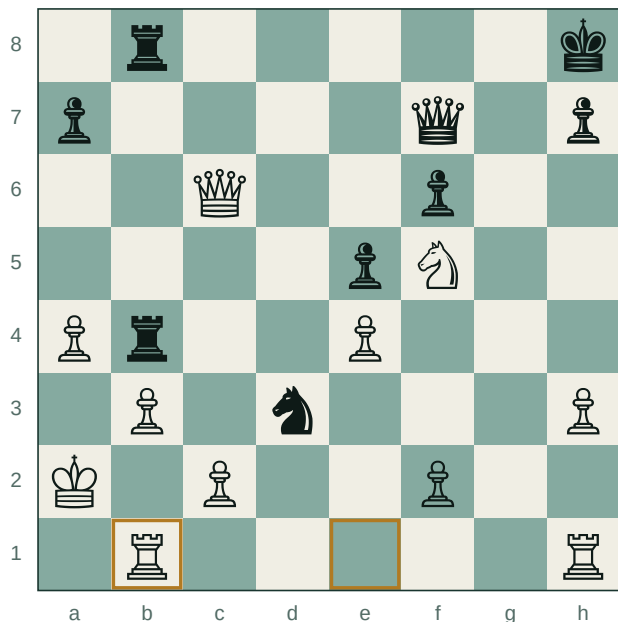


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 27

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Rb1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Rxb3 28. Rxb3 Nb4+ 29. Kb1 Nxc6 30. Rxb8+ Nxb8

27...Rxb3 The rook captures the pawn on b3. Recorded reply: **28.Rxb3**.

28...Nb4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From b4 it attacks king on a2 and queen on c6. Recorded reply: **29.Kb1**.

29...Nxc6 The knight captures the queen on c6. The changed line means the rook on b8 attacks the rook on b3. Recorded reply: **30.Rxb8+**.

30...Nxb8 The knight captures the rook on b8.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on a2. Absolute pin: pawn on b3.